A few days later, a well-networked banker friend called up from Mumbai. ‘Mukeshbhai is very angry with you. Why are you guys giving this Kejriwal any airtime at all?’ he asked. The unfriendly tone of the conversation surprised me. I had met Mukeshbhai on a few occasions in connection with an annual event, *Real Heroes*, which we did in partnership with Reliance. The event showcased stories of hope and courage shown by anonymous Indians and had become a big success. We had built a reasonable personal equation, or so I presumed. Whenever we met, he was always sharply insightful about India’s problems, bubbling with ideas and spoke with an almost obsessive vision of ‘Brand India’ and how he wanted to contribute to the India growth story.

I tried to explain to my banker friend that we had done almost a dozen Google+ Hangouts with BJP and Congress politicians. Kejriwal was just one more voice. ‘It’s your call, Rajdeep, but be prepared for a rough time from Reliance from now on,’ was the parting shot. Little did I know then that the moment the elections were over, Reliance would formally take over Network 18, a move that would eventually spur my resignation from the channels I had helped create.

The Ambanis’ disquiet with Kejriwal may have been driven by the sharply accusatory nature of the AAP leader’s campaign, but it was also symptomatic of a growing belief within corporate India that they were now under siege. In any social gathering, it was almost routine to hear an industrialist take off on the policies of the Manmohan Singh government. Jairam Ramesh, in his avatar as environment minister, was often singled out by the captains of industry. ‘He is responsible for at least a 1 or 2 per cent dip in our GDP,’ one of them told me. ‘Because of him so many of our projects are stuck.’

Jairam was equally strident. ‘There are three types of environment ministers. Those who just give a stamp to every project without even looking at it; those who are ATM ministers and want money for each approval; and those who implement the laws of the land. Business houses don’t like me because I reminded them of their environment violations,’ he told me in response to these accusations.